

app can be developed and deployed as per the functions and features required.

Some prominent open source tools for cross-platform app development are:

- Meteor
- Apache Cordova
- Appcelerator
- Qt
- Xamarin

In this article, we look at how to use the Meteor framework for developing apps.

Meteor

Meteor is a JavaScript based Web framework for mobile app development. Its URL is <https://www.meteor.com>, and the current version is 1.4.

Meteor or MeteorJS is a free and open source framework written in C, C++ and JavaScript. The source code repository of MeteorJS is available on <https://github.com/meteor/meteor>. The development of code for mobile apps can be done easily in the JavaScript programming model.

Meteor follows the reactive programming model, in which the client application/browser is not only used to display the data, but the reactions on real-time changes and updates are also done in parallel. Meteor escalates the performance of the mobile app as it works in real-time, by default.

Mobile apps for different OSs including Android, iOS and many others can be developed using MeteorOS. This framework has excellent features to integrate MongoDB for Big Data and high performance computing in mobile applications.

Installation of Meteor on Linux/OSX

To install Meteor on Linux/OSX, give the following command:

```
$ curl https://install.meteor.com/ | sh
```

The above command performs the following tasks:

1. Connects with install.meteor.com.
2. Downloads the latest stable release of Meteor.
3. Installs the required Meteor version.

Installation of Meteor on Windows

The installation of Meteor in Windows is quite straightforward. Simply download the installer from <https://install.meteor.com/windows>. The installation wizard will install the Meteor framework.

Once the MeteorJS framework is installed, the verification of the installed version can be done using the following command:

```
PathToMeteor> meteor --version
```

The features of MeteorJS are:

- Cross-platform native mobile app development.



Figure 1: Web page of Meteor or MeteorJS

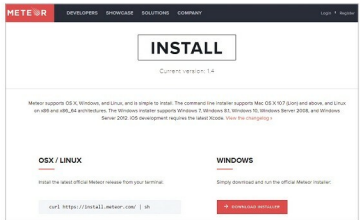


Figure 2: Installation Web page of Meteor

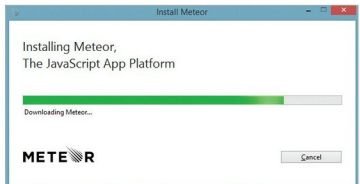


Figure 3: Installing Meteor on Windows

- Generation of apps for multiple working environments including Web browsers and mobile platforms.
- Enormous packages are available for different types of functions and modules.
- Integration of Meteor Galaxy for compatibility with the cloud.
- The apps created using Meteor work in real-time, as default.
- The programming structure of JavaScript is required for both client side as well as server side development.

Creating apps using Meteor

To create a new app in Meteor, the command `meteor create` is executed in the `installation` folder.

To create the app, run the `meteor create` command from the command prompt. Any name can be assigned to the app.

```
PathToMeteor>meteor create FirstMeteorApp
```